

VendorBridge

Design System & Front-End Specification

Direction: "MANIFEST & STAMP" — aged-paper procurement ledger, ink-navy type, oxblood approval-stamp accent.

Prepared for implementation. This document specifies palette, typography, component patterns, and a page-by-page build spec for all eleven screens of the VendorBridge Procurement & Vendor Management ERP. Build each screen to match the tokens and patterns defined here — treat this as the single source of truth for styling decisions.

Design theme overview

Name: Manifest & Stamp

The product is a procurement ERP, and procurement has always run on paperwork — manifests, stamped approvals, ledgers. Instead of hiding that heritage behind a generic SaaS look, this theme leans into it: warm aged-paper surfaces, ink-navy structure, and an oxblood "approved" stamp motif used as the recurring brand device (login screen, hero section, invoice document). The effect should read as trustworthy, official, and a little tactile — not cold or purely digital.

Design principles to preserve while building:

- Crisp, mostly-square corners (2px radius max). No soft/bubbly cards, no heavy drop shadows.
- Hairline borders (1–1.5px) do the separating work instead of shadows or big gaps.
- Every numeric / code value (PO numbers, GST numbers, prices, dates, timestamps) is set in monospace — this is a deliberate signal that the data is "real record", not just UI copy.
- The circular stamp mark (used in the logo) reappears as a literal rotated "APPROVED" stamp wherever a document is finalised: hero section, invoice, login panel.
- Status is always color + label together (never color alone) — green/approved, oxblood/pending or rejected, muted-ink/issued or neutral.

Color palette

Two surface systems: a warm paper system for marketing / vendor-facing screens, and the same paper system with an ink sidebar for the internal app shell. Do not introduce new colors outside this list — every accent on every screen must map back to one of these tokens.

Token	Hex	Role	Swatch
--paper	#EDE6D6	Primary background (warm aged paper)	
--paper-deep	#E4DBC7	Secondary section background / stripes	
--card	#F4EFE3	Card / panel surface (sits above paper)	
--paper-line	#C9C0A8	Hairline borders, table rules, dividers	
--ink	#231F16	Primary text, structural borders, sidebar bg	
--ink-soft	#4A4535	Secondary text on paper	
--muted	#6B6349	Tertiary / caption text	
--oxblood	#8A3223	Primary accent: CTAs, stamp, active nav, pending status	
--green	#4B6B4A	Success / approved status only	
--amber	#9C7A2E	Warning / review-pending status only	
--sidebar	#231F16	App-shell sidebar background	
--sidebar-text	#D8CFB8	Sidebar nav text	
--sidebar-muted	#8C8368	Sidebar inactive nav / section labels	

CSS custom properties — drop this block into :root as-is:

```
:root{
  --paper:#EDE6D6;
  --paper-deep:#E4DBC7;
  --card:#F4EFE3;
  --paper-line:#C9C0A8;
  --ink:#231F16;
  --ink-soft:#4A4535;
  --muted:#6B6349;
  --oxblood:#8A3223;
  --green:#4B6B4A;
  --amber:#9C7A2E;
  --sidebar:#231F16;
  --sidebar-text:#D8CFB8;
  --sidebar-muted:#8C8368;
  --radius:2px;
}
```

Status color mapping (use consistently across vendors, quotations, approvals, POs, invoices):

Status	Color token	Used for
Approved / Active / Issued	--green (bg 15% tint, text full)	Approved quotation, active vendor, issued PO/invoice

Status	Color token	Used for
Pending / Under review	--oxblood (bg 12% tint, text full)	Pending approval, quotation awaiting decision
Rejected	--oxblood, solid	Rejected quotation / RFQ
Inactive / Neutral	--muted (bg 8% ink tint)	Inactive vendor, closed record

Typography system

Three font families, each with a fixed job. Never substitute one for another's role — the mono-for-data rule in particular is a core part of the theme, not a stylistic accident.

Role	Family	Weights	Used for
Display / Headings	Fraunces (serif)	600, 700	h1, h2, h3 — all headline and section-title text
Body	IBM Plex Sans	400, 500, 6 00	Paragraphs, labels, buttons, nav, descriptions
Data / Mono	IBM Plex Mono	400, 500, 600	PO/RFQ/GST numbers, prices, dates, timestamps, eyebrow labels, badges

Google Fonts import (place at top of stylesheet):

```
@import url('https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Fraunces:opsz,wght@9..144,600;9..144,700&family=IBM+Plex+Mono');
```

```
h1, h2, h3      { font-family:'Fraunces', serif; font-weight:600; }
body, p, button { font-family:'IBM Plex Sans', sans-serif; }
.mono          { font-family:'IBM Plex Mono', monospace; }
```

Type scale:

Element	Size	Weight	Notes
Hero H1	34–54px (clamp)	600	Fraunces, line-height 1.06–1.1, italic used for emphasis word
Section H2	26–36px	600	Fraunces
Card H3 / H4	15–18px	600	Fraunces
Body copy	13–16.5px	400	IBM Plex Sans, line-height 1.5–1.6
Eyebrow label	11–12px	500, uppercase, 0.12em tracking	IBM Plex Mono, oxblood, small leading dash before text
Mono data (PO#, price, date)	11–14px	400–500	IBM Plex Mono, always

Core component patterns

Buttons

Primary: solid ink background, paper text, hover swaps to oxblood. Ghost/secondary: transparent with 1.5px ink border. Both use IBM Plex Mono for the label, uppercase tracking optional, 2px radius.

```
.btn{
  padding:11px 20px; border-radius:2px;
  border:1.5px solid var(--ink);
  background:var(--ink); color:var(--paper);
  font-family:'IBM Plex Mono'; font-size:13px; cursor:pointer;
}
.btn:hover{ background:var(--oxblood); border-color:var(--oxblood); }
.btn-ghost{ background:transparent; color:var(--ink); }
```

Status badges

```
.badge{
  font-family:'IBM Plex Mono'; font-size:10.5px; text-transform:uppercase;
  padding:3px 9px; border-radius:20px; letter-spacing:0.03em;
}
.badge.approved{ background:rgba(75,107,74,0.15); color:var(--green); }
.badge.pending{ background:rgba(138,50,35,0.12); color:var(--oxblood); }
.badge.inactive{ background:rgba(35,31,22,0.08); color:var(--muted); }
```

Cards / panels

Flat card surface (--card) on a 1.5px solid ink border. No shadow. A panel-head strip with a bottom border separates the title from the body. This pattern repeats for dashboard panels, form cards, and feature cards.

```
.card{ border:1.5px solid var(--ink); background:var(--card); }
.card-head{ padding:16px 24px; border-bottom:1.5px solid var(--ink); }
.card-body{ padding:22px 24px; }
```

The approval stamp motif

A rotated circular "stamp" is the single most important recurring brand device. Use it wherever a record has been finalised or approved — hero section, login panel, invoice document. Do not overuse it inside ordinary UI (only on documents / key moments, roughly one per screen at most).

```
.stamp{
  width:120px; height:120px; border:3px solid var(--oxblood); border-radius:50%;
  color:var(--oxblood); display:flex; align-items:center; justify-content:center;
  text-align:center; font-family:'IBM Plex Mono'; font-weight:700; font-size:11px;
  transform:rotate(-13deg); letter-spacing:0.06em;
}
```

Ledger rows / tables

Data lists (recent activity, vendor tables, line items) use hairline row dividers, never zebra striping. Header row sits on --paper-deep with mono uppercase labels. Numeric columns are always right-aligned and mono.

```
thead th{
  font-family:'IBM Plex Mono'; font-size:10.5px; text-transform:uppercase;
  color:var(--muted); background:var(--paper-deep);
  border-bottom:1.5px solid var(--ink); padding:13px 18px; text-align:left;
}
tbody td{ padding:15px 18px; border-bottom:1px solid var(--paper-line); font-size:13.5px; }
tbody tr:hover{ background:var(--paper-deep); }
```

Page shells

A — Marketing shell (landing page only)

- Sticky top nav, 1.5px bottom border, logo mark + wordmark on the left, nav links center, Sign in / primary CTA on the right.
- Sections alternate --paper and --paper-deep backgrounds, separated by 1.5–2px solid ink rules (not shadows).
- Max content width 1180px, side padding 44px desktop / 22px mobile.

B — App shell (all internal screens: dashboard, vendors, RFQ, quotations, approvals, PO/invoice, activity, reports)

- Fixed left sidebar, 238px wide, --sidebar (ink) background, --sidebar-text nav labels.
- Sidebar grouped into labelled sections (Overview / Procurement / Insights) using mono uppercase 10.5px section labels.
- Active nav item: left border accent in amber (#D89A57), slightly lighter row background, --paper text.
- User identity pinned to the bottom of the sidebar: colored initials avatar (oxblood for internal roles, green for vendor role) + name + mono role label.
- Topbar: page title (Fraunces h1) + mono meta subtitle on the left; search / actions / primary button on the right. 1.5px bottom border, no shadow.
- Content area padding: 28–34px top, 36px sides.

```
.sidebar{ width:238px; background:var(--sidebar); color:var(--sidebar-text); }
.sb-item.active{
  color:var(--paper); background:rgba(237,230,214,0.06);
  border-left:2px solid #D89A57;
}
.topbar{
  display:flex; justify-content:space-between; align-items:center;
  padding:20px 36px; border-bottom:1.5px solid var(--ink);
}
```

Logo & brand mark

Mark: a circular seal (echoes the approval-stamp motif) containing a minimal suspension-bridge glyph — two piers, an arched cable line, an oxblood keystone dot at the apex. Reads literally as "bridge" while tying back to the stamped-document language used throughout the product.

Delivered assets:

- vendorbridge-icon.svg — mark alone, for favicon / app icon
- vendorbridge-logo-light.svg — full horizontal lockup, for paper/light backgrounds
- vendorbridge-logo-dark.svg — full horizontal lockup, for ink/dark backgrounds
- vendorbridge-logo-stacked.svg — icon over wordmark, for square placements

Wordmark is set in Fraunces 600. Minimum clear space around the mark equals the diameter of its own seal ring. Do not recolor the mark outside the ink/paper/oxblood-amber system defined above.

Page-by-page build specification

Eleven screens total. Each entry below lists purpose, shell, and the sections/components required. Build in this order; the app shell (sidebar/topbar) should be built once and reused from screen 3 onward.

01 — Landing page

SHELL: MARKETING SHELL

Purpose: Public-facing marketing page introducing VendorBridge.

- Sticky nav: logo, Platform/Workflow/Roles links, Sign in + Request-a-walkthrough CTA.
 - Hero: eyebrow + Fraunces H1 with oxblood italic emphasis word, lede paragraph, two CTAs, a live-looking "ledger preview" table (RFQ/QT/PO codes, vendor, status badge, amount), and a rotated approval stamp graphic.
 - 3-column trust strip on --paper-deep: one-record / role-scoped / timestamped.
 - Feature grid: 6 cards (Vendor Mgmt, RFQ Creation, Quotation Comparison, Approval Workflow, PO & Invoicing, Reports & Analytics), numbered 01–06, 1px hairline grid on ink border.
 - 8-step workflow trail (numbered, horizontal or stacked) walking RFQ → activity log.
 - 4 role cards (Procurement Officer, Vendor, Manager/Approver, Admin) styled as ID cards with a dashed top edge and bullet responsibility list.
 - Closing CTA band + minimal footer.
-

02 — Login / Signup

SHELL: AUTH SCREEN (NO SIDEBAR)

Purpose: Authenticate users; scoped by role after login.

- Split screen: left panel is ink-background brand panel with logo, a short brand line, and a small live-metric mono list (active vendors / open RFQs / pending approvals).
 - Right panel: tab toggle (Sign in / Create account), email + password fields, remember-me + forgot-password row, primary submit button, footer link to switch tabs.
 - Signup variant adds a role selector (4 tappable role chips) and name/company fields.
-

03 — Dashboard

SHELL: APP SHELL

Purpose: Landing screen after login; at-a-glance procurement status.

- Topbar with date + system-status mono subline, search input, notification bell, + New RFQ button.
 - 4-up stat cards: Pending Approvals, Active RFQs, Purchase Orders (MTD), Invoiced (MTD) — each with a mono delta line (up/warn colored).
 - 2-column panel row: "Recent purchase orders" ledger table (left, wider) and "Pending your approval" list with inline approve/reject icon buttons (right).
 - Quick actions panel: 4 dashed-border action tiles (Create RFQ, Register vendor, Compare quotations, Generate report).
-

04 — Vendor Management

SHELL: APP SHELL

Purpose: Maintain the vendor registry.

- Topbar shows total/active vendor counts; + Register vendor button.
 - Filter chip row (All / Active / Under review / Inactive with counts) + search input.
 - Table columns: Vendor name + GSTIN sub-line, Category tag, GST number (mono), Contact email, Star rating, Status badge, row action link.
 - Pagination row (mono, showing X–Y of N).
-

05 — RFQ Creation

SHELL: APP SHELL, MULTI-STEP FORM

Purpose: Officer creates and issues a Request for Quotation.

- 4-step progress indicator: Details → Line items → Vendors → Review (done/active/pending states).
 - Card 1 — RFQ details: title, category select, deadline date, description textarea.
 - Card 2 — Line items: editable table (item / qty / unit) with add-line action, plus an attachment dropzone.
 - Card 3 — Vendor assignment: selected-vendor chips with remove (x), + Add vendor chip.
 - Footer actions: Save draft (ghost) and Continue/Send (primary).
-

06 — Vendor Quotation Submission

SHELL: APP SHELL (VENDOR ROLE), AVATAR GREEN

Purpose: Vendor responds to an RFQ with pricing and terms.

- RFQ brief banner at top: title + scope description (left), requester name + deadline (right, mono, deadline in oxblood).
 - Pricing card: editable line-item table (item, qty, unit price input, computed line total), subtotal row.
 - Delivery & terms card: delivery timeline input, quotation-valid-until date, notes textarea.
 - Footer actions: Save as draft (ghost) and Submit quotation (primary).
-

07 — Quotation Comparison

SHELL: APP SHELL

Purpose: Compare all vendor responses to one RFQ side by side.

- Sort chip row (Lowest price / Fastest delivery / Highest rated) + received-count mono label.
 - Comparison table: one column per vendor, rows for Total price, Delivery timeline, Valid-until, Notes, Decision.
 - Winning vendor's column tinted with a soft green background and a "Lowest price" tag; lowest-price and fastest-delivery values individually highlighted in green.
 - Decision row uses a Select button per column, filled/green once chosen.
-

08 — Approval Workflow

SHELL: APP SHELL (APPROVER ROLE)

Purpose: Manager approves or rejects a selected quotation.

- 2-column layout: request summary + action card (left, wider), approval timeline (right).
 - Summary card: status pill, key-value rows (vendor, RFQ, requested by, delivery timeline, submitted date, total value in oxblood mono), remarks textarea, Approve (green solid) / Reject (oxblood outline) buttons full-width side by side.
 - Timeline card: vertical connected-dot list (done=green check, current=oxblood filled, pending=hollow outline) with timestamp + optional italic remark under each entry.
-

09 — Purchase Order & Invoice

SHELL: APP SHELL, DOCUMENT VIEW

Purpose: Generate, view, and dispatch the final invoice document.

- Topbar actions: Download PDF (ghost), Print (ghost), Send via email (primary).
 - Centered document card styled like a physical invoice: company header + address block, invoice number/date top-right, a rotated "Payment approved" stamp in the corner.
 - Two-column meta block: Billed-to vendor details / PO reference details.
 - Line-items table with right-aligned mono numeric columns, totals block (subtotal, GST, freight, bold grand total in oxblood).
 - Document footer: generated-by note + page number, small muted text.
-

10 — Activity Logs & Notifications

SHELL: APP SHELL

Purpose: Full audit trail plus a notifications side panel.

- Filter chip row (All / RFQs / Approvals / Invoices / Vendors).
 - Log list: timestamp (mono) + colored round icon (create/approve/reject/send, each a distinct tint) + title/description + actor name, right-aligned.
 - Right rail: Notifications panel (tag + message + relative time per item, unread count in header) and an Export panel (CSV / PDF buttons).
-

11 — Reports & Analytics

SHELL: APP SHELL (ADMIN ROLE)

Purpose: Procurement spend and vendor-performance insights.

- 4-up stat cards: Total spend YTD, Purchase orders, Avg approval time, Active vendors, each with a green mono delta.
 - 2-column panel row: CSS/SVG bar chart of monthly spend (left, wider) and a donut chart of spend-by-category with a text legend (right).
 - Vendor performance table: vendor name, order count (mono), on-time-delivery inline progress bar, star rating.
-

Implementation notes for the build

- Build the design-token stylesheet (palette + fonts + component CSS from sections 02–04) once, shared across every screen — do not restate values per page.
- Build the app shell (sidebar + topbar) as one reusable layout component; screens 03–11 only differ in the content area.
- All monetary values in the reference mockups use **■** (INR) formatting with lakh/rore grouping — keep this unless told otherwise.
- Every status badge, stamp, and colored delta must use the status color mapping in section 02 — do not invent new status colors per screen.
- Corners: 2px radius everywhere except the circular stamp and avatars (50%) and pill badges (20px). No large border-radius anywhere else.
- No box-shadows in the reference design — depth comes from borders and flat background-color changes only.

Follow this document as the single source of truth for palette, typography, and component styling across all eleven VendorBridge screens.